

MORE THAN ONE

*Spreading Plural Awareness by
Sharing Plural Experiences*

ISSUE #001: SYSCOVERY

SYSCOVERY - HOW DO YOU KNOW

YOU'RE PLURAL?

By the Fencer Hivemind

For many who have just become aware of plurality, the answer to this may seem obvious: after all, wouldn't you notice other people in your head? Surprisingly, usually not.

While some systems may have always been aware of their plurality, it's more common to only figure out you're plural later, as the result of a complicated self-discovery process referred to by the plural community as "syscovery".

There are a number of reasons for this, one of which is the lack of plural awareness in society as a whole. This zine aims to help address that issue by sharing experiences from a wide variety of systems.

Additionally, for systems that formed in response to trauma, the lack of knowledge about their plurality may be a part of that defense mechanism, keeping knowledge of trauma limited to certain system members.

The main factor, however, is that plurality isn't as

entities, rather than a spiritual one. Sprul pa are still an important concept in Tibetan Buddhism, so it is important to note that despite being etymologically related the two terms and the practices surrounding them are very different.

Tulpamancer- Someone who creates a tulpa.

Tulpamancy- The process/practice of creating a tulpa.

Introject- A headmate based on/embodying traits of an outside source.

Fictive- An introject whose source is a fictional character.

Subsystem- A system within a system, a group of headmates more closely linked to one another than other system members.

Cocon- Short for "coconscious". Refers to the state of being close to front, fronting alongside someone else, or otherwise being present but not otherwise in control of the body.

HELPFUL VOCABULARY

Syscovery– The process of discovering one’s own systemhood/plurality.

Median– Between multiple and singlet on the plural spectrum. Also known as midcontinuum systems, median systems have headmates that are not as distinct from one another as in other systems.

Tulpa– A term used to describe headmates that were created, either accidentally or deliberately, usually through repeated interaction and various other techniques. This term was borrowed from Tibetan “sprul pa”, referring to a Tibetan Buddhist spiritual practice. Tulpas as a concept derive more from western Spiritualism, and the term has since undergone shifts in meaning. Most modern tulpas and tulpamancers see tulpas as a psychological phenomenon, where the brain is essentially trained to think as separate

internally obvious as one might expect. In this issue, we’ll present a number of different perspectives from different kinds of systems regarding their syscovery process, whatever that means for them. This could be anything from how they discovered their systemhood, to how they found the plural community, to their journeys of self(or selves)–acceptance.

SYSTEM STORIES

Prompt: Tell the story of your system's syscovery, whatever that means to you.

We are a cyclic system, which means that our plurality comes and goes in cycles. I have had 3 cycles so far. I can't exactly remember how the first one came about, other than it had a really big explosion from around 5 members to 25+. the second cycle was median and during the worst time of my life (I am the "original", although I don't like that term), and most of the splinters (as I call them) were embodiments of things I embraced at the time. it ended quite quickly, spanning from May to July of 2025. the good thing about it is that I get to experience the confusion of syscovery over and over (I'm a very curious soul), but the bad thing is that its unpredictable and a little overwhelming.

-Kris/weirdosona

QUESTIONS ABOUT PLURALITY?

*Email them to
thefencerhivemind@gmail.com or
submit them anonymously by
scanning the QR code below!*



ASK-A-SYSTEM!

Questions submitted anonymously. Answers provided by the Fencer Hivemind.

Q: Is Tulpamancy a form of plurality???

A: Yep! While the tulpamancy community is sort of its own thing with a history separate from the broader plural community, it does fall under the umbrella of plurality, and there are plenty of tulpamancers and tulpas that are active in the broader plural community as well.

Several years ago, back in... I wanna say in 2018 or something? We were struggling heavily with identity issues. At the time, we assumed a single identity– but it would always change. We would behave vastly different one day, and redo our entire online presence the next. We must have gone through dozens of usernames, sonas, and names in–person, that we thought was just a trans and neurodivergent thing! We were familiar with concepts like tulpas and alternate personalities, but we never really considered it for ourselves– until one of our headmates at the time, Abysal, came out to the host and spoke to them as a separate person. Abysal was one of the usernames we had used for a bit. I think we kinda thought we had accidentally made a tulpa? And we kept it a secret for awhile, saying they were just a friend of ours whenever they spoke online. I don't know, I guess they were scared or ashamed. Abysal showed complete agency from the host, and ended up becoming their best friend/QPR though. They said they knew for awhile, that they were watching, keeping us safe. It was them who allowed us to discover who we were, and they're still around to this day.

Some time afterwards, we started researching plurality, since we knew deep down that it wasn't as simple as having DID– that we weren't "broken", despite

whatever symptoms showed up. We discovered that we had a ton of different headmates that manifested previously as different daydream characters, comfort characters that were actually introjects, and more that only made sense when we discovered what plurality truly was! Since that time we've grown to discover a lot more about our system and ourselves, it's been a fantastic creative outlet for us all and we know more than ever before. That's what I remember of it!

-Infinite Goobers in a Trenchcoat

The first time we looked into plurality, we had no clue it applied to us. A comic by a system about fictives had popped up on our Tumblr dash, and we got curious, looked through some of the tags, and fell down an ADHD research rabbithole. Then we moved on and didn't think about it again for a while.

We were questioning our gender identity for a long time before we figured out we were plural. For a while we thought we were genderfluid, but that never felt quite right. On top of the gender stuff, there were times when a few pseudonyms we used felt more right than our birth name, even though they were just as feminine, if not more so. (We're AFAB, for context). I remember once we looked up if genderfluid people ever went by different names at different times, and we

Take your time! Self/selves-discovery can take a while. Don't feel pressured to figure it all out right away. Listen to other systems talk about their experiences and see what you resonate with. If you ever feel like you're faking, remember that you can't fake being a system unintentionally. You can think you're a system for a while and then realize you aren't actually plural, but that's okay! Being mistaken is not the same thing as "faking", and either way you've learned something about yourself/selves. Don't be afraid to try out different labels and see what fits.

-The Fencer Hivemind

If you could offer one piece of advice to someone questioning if they're plural, what would it be?

You're plural if you choose to identify as such. Don't let anyone gatekeep you, and don't feel pressured to identify as plural if it doesn't feel right. You are plural if you identify as a more than one person, whether that's separate identities, sub-identities within a system-wide identity, or any other configuration. You can't be "wrong" about how you identify, so it's not about objective truth; it's about what feels right to you/y'all.

-Infinite Goobers in a Trenchcoat

do a little bit of soul searching, i guess! meditate, lucid dream, try to visualize, recall any experience related to plurality... or start to document any mental changes, if you can't dedicate yourself as much! write in a journal saying "if anyone's here, introduce yourself" and see if anyone responds!

-Kris/weirdosona

found someone asking a similar question on like, Quora or Reddit or something like that, and only one of the responses was "yes", and it had an edit saying they had later found out they were a system.

*The next thing that set us up for realizing we might be plural was actually a fanfic. It was about some character we liked figuring out they were plural, and it was written by a system. It looked interesting, so we read it. That was sorta the first thing that clued us in to how inobvious plurality can be, even internally. Our system is monoconscious, meaning switching tends to feel more like **becoming** someone else rather than losing control or taking over. The system in the fanfic was the same way. They also rationalized their headmates as moods, ex: "cleaning mood", "work mood", "talking with friends mood", which is similar to how we rationalized our plurality before we realized we were plural.*

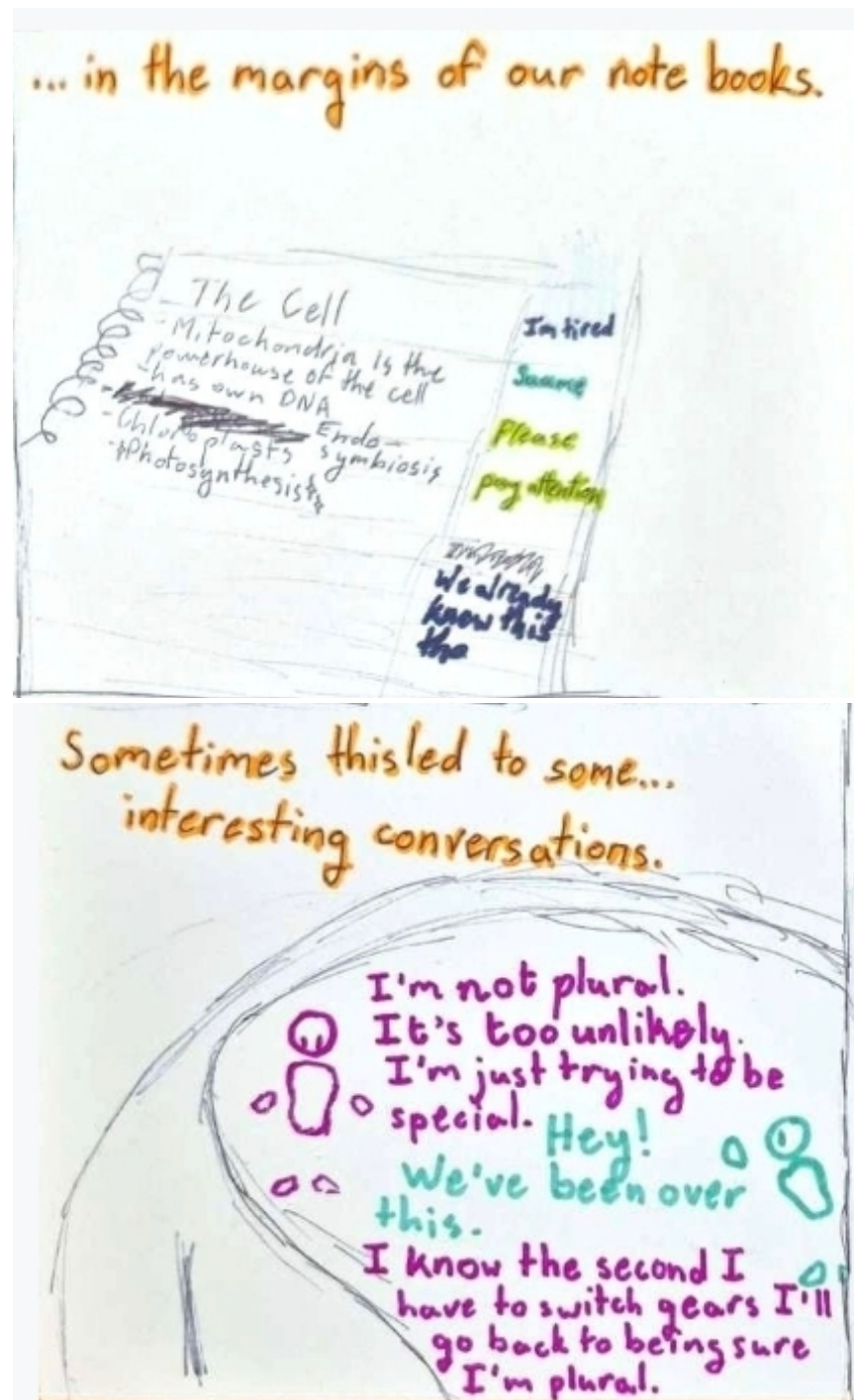
All that is just set up: stuff we had to know before even considering the possibility we might be a system. We still didn't realize until we first consciously noticed a switch. I think we were about 16 at the time? We had been pacing around downstairs (we're autistic/adhd and pacing is one of our main stims), actively thinking about our gender issues. We don't remember exactly who was fronting, but it was definitely a member of the Turquoise subsystem, and all of them are pretty femme.

Then, our mom fell down the stairs and started yelling, we panicked, whoever was fronting didn't know what to do, and Edgar, who is one of our more masc headmates, switched in and snuck down to the basement.

Because we were actively paying attention to our sense of gender identity at the time, and because the switch was so abrupt, we actually noticed what was going on, and realized that what had just happened seemed a lot more like plurality than just genderfluidity, given that it was in response to an external stimulus and our thought process and emotional reaction to the situation seemed to change along with our gender.

Anyway, Edgar spent the next hour or so watching soap making videos on our phone while trying to ignore the Turquoises having a crisis in cocon. It took a lot of questioning and self-reflection from there to figure out who we were, individually, and how our system worked, plus a fairly long time for everyone to work through the denial phase and all that. Interacting with other systems, hearing their stories and all that, really helped us, which is a huge part of why we decided to make this zine!

-The Fencer Hivemind



When we were first figuring out
we were plural...

We would write
out our thoughts

like a
stream of consciousness

I'm not plural.

LOL

I just wish I could convince
myself of that.

...and it never occurred
to you that's a sign That is
we are actually plural? literally

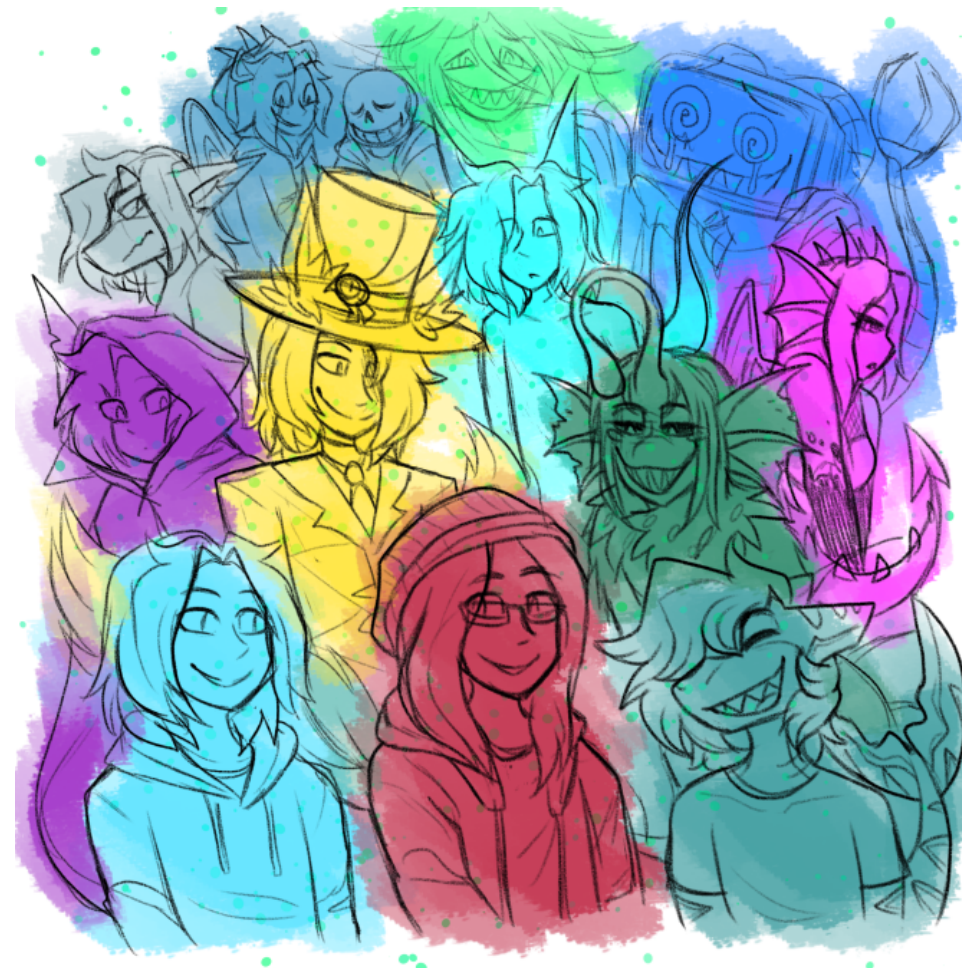
We might not be the most plural
plural yet but if thing I've ever
we keep this up we heard.

will be. Are you even hearing
yourself?

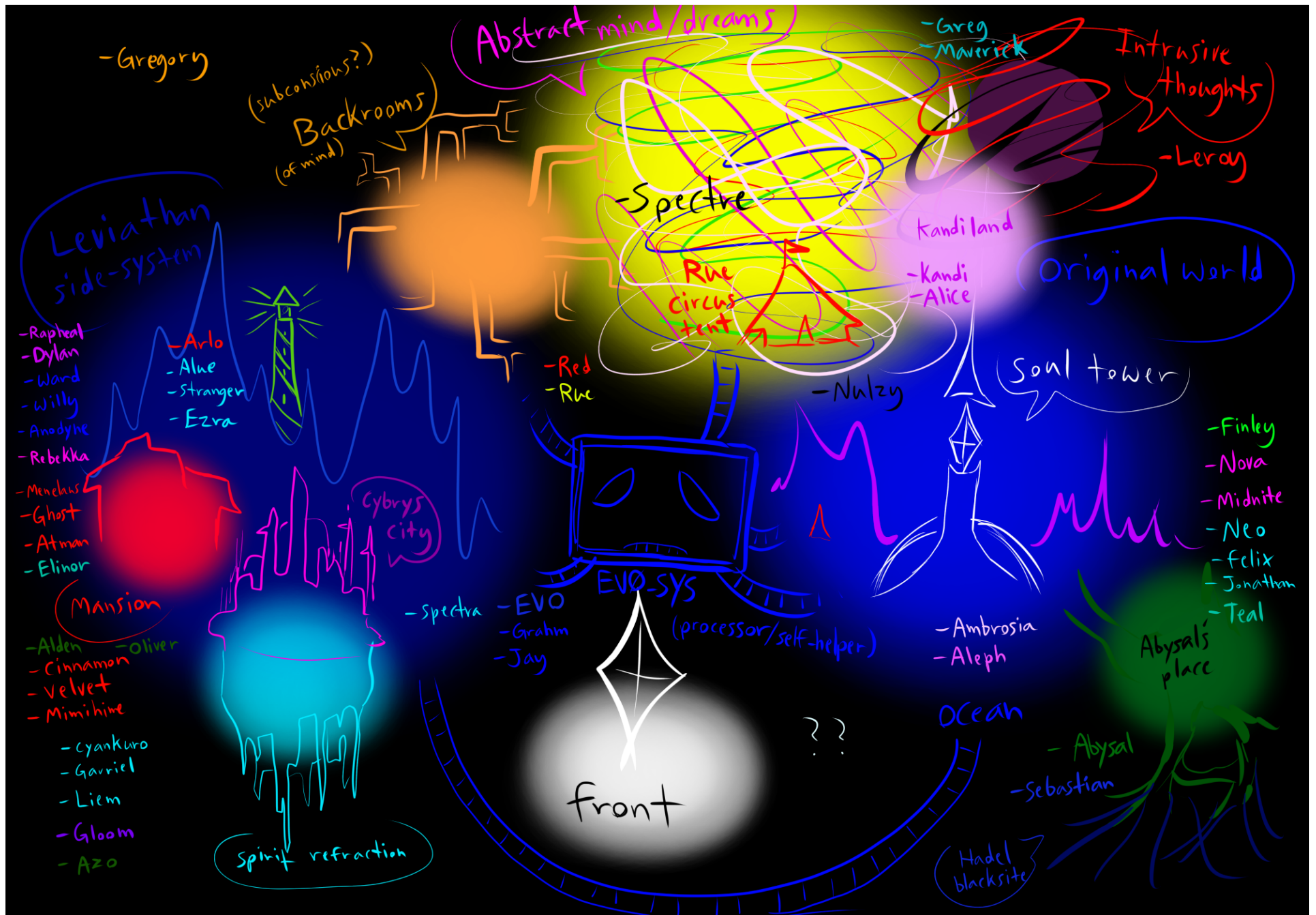
This is hilarious.

Comic by the Fencer Hivemind

PLURAL ART



A group of our headmates by DreamingLeviathanSystem



Map of our headspace by DreamingLeviathanSystem

